全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 50 單元 | 抽象與其他 · Abstract & Other

The Climb to Grandpa's Hill

爬上爺爺的那座山

Every year on Tomb Sweeping Day, the Chen family gathers on a hillside in Miaoli where their ancestors are buried. For Hsiao-an, a sixteen-year-old who would rather spend the holiday with her friends, the trip has always seemed a tiresome necessity. This year, however, an unexpected incident changed her view. Her eighty-two-year-old grandfather insisted on climbing the steep path to the tomb himself instead of waiting in the car, and no one in the family was able to stop him.

The process of cleaning the tomb involves pulling weeds, repainting the faded characters on the stone, and offering food and prayers. Halfway up, Grandpa's legs began to shake, and Hsiao-an took his arm. "Why do you insist on this?" she asked. "You could rely on us to do it." He was silent for a moment. Then he said, "My father carried me up this hill when I was five. His presence is still here. If I stop coming, somehow a part of my identity goes with him." Hsiao-an did not fully understand, but she felt the significance of his words.

At the tomb, the family worked together with a unity she had not noticed before. Her uncle, who usually argued with her father about every issue, passed him the brush. Her mother, who is not religious, bowed with the others. Grandpa explained that the ritual is not about religion alone; it is a spiritual reminder that each person represents a link in a long chain, and that the virtues of the people before us are an inheritance we should honor.

On the way down, Hsiao-an realized that the trend among her friends of skipping family rituals for the sake of free time came with a hidden risk: the loss of knowing who you are. The outcome of the day was not a miracle, and she may still complain next year. But she now tends to see the climb differently, not as an obstacle to her weekend, but as a small sacrifice that keeps a family's story alive.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句

necessity	*n.*	必需品；必要	In Taiwan, an umbrella is a daily necessity. 在台灣，雨傘是日常必需品。
incident	*n.*	事件	The teacher reported the incident to the principal. 老師把這起事件報告給校長。
involve	*v.*	包含；牽涉	The job involves a lot of traveling. 這份工作需要經常出差。
rely	*v.*	依靠；信賴	You can rely on him to keep a secret. 你可以信賴他會保守祕密。
identity	*n.*	身分；認同	The police are trying to find out the man's identity. 警方正試圖查出那名男子的身分。
significance	*n.*	重要性；意義	The teacher explained the significance of the festival. 老師解釋了這個節日的意義。
unity	*n.*	團結；一致	The coach asked the team to show unity on the field. 教練要求球隊在場上展現團結。
spiritual	*adj.*	心靈的；精神上的	Many people visit temples for spiritual peace. 許多人到廟裡尋求心靈的平靜。
sacrifice	*n.*	犧牲	Her parents made many sacrifices so she could study abroad. 她的父母做了許多犧牲，好讓她能出國念書。
obstacle	*n.*	障礙；阻礙	Lack of money was the biggest obstacle to his dream. 缺錢是他夢想的最大障礙。

片語 Phrases

would rather	寧願	I would rather stay home than go shopping. 我寧願待在家也不要去逛街。
for the sake of	為了	He gave up smoking for the sake of his health. 他為了健康戒菸了。
on the way	在途中	We stopped for breakfast on the way to school. 我們在上學途中停下來吃早餐。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + insist on + V-ing / N

insist on 表示「堅持」，後面接動名詞或名詞，說明堅持要做的事情。

Grandpa insisted on climbing the hill himself.

爺爺堅持要自己爬上那座山。

not A but B

not A but B 表示「不是 A 而是 B」，A 和 B 必須是相同的詞性或結構（例如都是名詞片語或介系詞片語）。

She sees the climb not as an obstacle but as a small sacrifice.

她把這段爬坡看成不是阻礙，而是小小的犧牲。

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